Build Your Own Career Roadmap

A simple framework + one prompt that builds your week by week plan for any tech or finance role.

Freshers | Job switch | Role change | Tech | Finance

Inside: the 6-step framework, the master prompt, 3 ready examples, and a weekly tracking checklist.

nikhiltiwary.in

What's inside

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1. Why one roadmap does not fit all

You have watched many roadmap videos. You have saved posts and made lists. But on Monday morning, you still don't know what to study.

That's not your fault. Most roadmaps are made for an average person who does not exist. Your plan depends on things a YouTuber cannot know about you:

- **Your starting point.** A fresher, a career switcher and a 4-year developer need very different plans, even for the same role.
- **Your end point.** First job, internship, role change, or job switch. Each one has a different path.
- **Your time.** 2 hours a day with a full-time job is not the same as 6 hours a day as a student.
- **Your deadline.** 3 months, 6 months, or next year's placement season.

> **The core idea**
>
> Same destination does not mean same route. Your roadmap must start from where you are, not from where someone else was.

2. The 6-step framework

Every good roadmap, whether you make it by hand or with AI, follows these 6 steps. The prompt in this guide does all of them for you. But knowing them helps you check if the plan you get is actually good.

Step 1: Know your starting point

Write down your education, experience, skills, tools and certifications. Be honest. Overrating yourself makes the plan skip things you actually need.

Step 2: Define your end point clearly

Not just "a job in tech". Pick one role, one type of company, and what success means. "Data Analyst offer at a startup in 6 months" is a goal. "Get into data" is not.

Step 3: Count your real hours

Weekdays and weekends are different. Count both separately and multiply. This number decides everything else.

Step 4: Find the skill gap

List the skills the role needs. Mark what you already have. The remaining list is your syllabus. Nothing more.

Step 5: Plan backwards in phases

Split your time into phases, then months, then weeks. Every week must end with one thing you can show or measure.

Step 6: Track every week and adjust

Check your progress every Sunday. If you fall behind, adjust the next week. Don't restart the whole plan.

Step 3 in action: count your hours

Here is how the math works. Say you can give 2 hours on weekdays and 5 hours on weekends, for 6 months:

Item	Calculation	Hours
Weekdays	2 hours x 5 days	10 per week
Weekends	5 hours x 2 days	10 per week
Per week	10 + 10	20
Per month	20 x ~4.3 weeks	~86
Total (6 months)	20 x 26 weeks	~520

520 hours is your real budget. Any plan that needs more than this is a fake plan.

Step 5 in action: a typical phase split

This is a rough guide. The prompt adjusts it to your situation. A switcher with strong basics may skip most of Phase 1.

Phase	Share of time	Focus
1. Foundations	~20 to 25%	Core basics the role assumes you know
2. Core skills	~30 to 35%	Role-specific skills and tools
3. Projects	~20 to 25%	Portfolio work that proves your skills
4. Job hunt	~20%	Resume, LinkedIn, referrals, applications, interview prep

> **Tip**
> Don't wait until the end to start the job hunt. Updating your LinkedIn and talking to people should start early. The prompt maps these to specific weeks.

3. How to use the prompt

- **Step 1.** Copy the master prompt on the next page.
- **Step 2.** Fill every [_____] with your details. Keep it short and honest.
- **Step 3.** Open Claude (claude.ai or the app). Turn on **Code execution and file creation** in Settings so it can make the PDF.
- **Step 4.** Paste the prompt and send. It will not ask you anything. It just builds the plan.
- **Step 5.** Download the PDF, print it, and start Week 1 on Monday.

Tips for filling the details

- **Be specific with skills.** "Python basics, can write loops and functions" is better than "Python".
- **Give real hours, not dream hours.** If you have a job, 1.5 to 2 hours on weekdays is honest. Plans built on 6 hours a day after work usually break in week 2.
- **Pick one target role.** "Data Analyst or Data Scientist or ML Engineer" gives a confused plan. Pick one.
- **Mention constraints.** Budget, language, notice period, college exams. They change the plan.
- **Left something blank?** No problem. The prompt makes a reasonable guess and lists it under Assumptions. Just check that section.

> **Note**
> No file creation option? The prompt still works. You will get the full roadmap in the chat. Copy it into a doc and you are good to go.

4. The master prompt

Copy everything in the box. Fill the blanks. Paste and send.

```
ROLE: You are a senior career strategist and hiring manager with deep experience in tech and finance hiring. Build a complete, realistic career roadmap for me.

=== MY DETAILS (filled in by me) ===
1. Current situation:
   - Education (degree, field, year): [_____]
   - Current job / status (student, employed, career switcher, unemployed): [_____]
   - Years of experience and in what: [_____]
   - Current skills (technical and soft): [_____]
   - Tools/software I already know: [_____]
   - Certifications I already have: [_____]
   - Location / target job market (country or city, remote OK?): [_____]
2. Goal:
   - Target domain (e.g., Tech, Finance, FinTech): [_____]
   - Target job role (e.g., Data Analyst, SDE, Investment Banking Analyst, Risk Analyst): [_____]
   - Target company type (startup, MNC, Big Tech, bank, fund, any): [_____]
   - What "success" means for me (e.g., land an offer, first interview, switch internally): [_____]
3. Time commitment:
   - Total timeline: [___] months
   - Weekday hours per day (Mon–Fri): [___] hours
   - Weekend hours per day (Sat–Sun): [___] hours
4. Constraints (optional): budget for courses, language, anything else: [_____]

=== STRICT RULES ===
- Do NOT ask me any questions. Do not ask for confirmation. Start immediately.
- If any field is blank or unclear, make a reasonable assumption, state it in an "Assumptions" section, and continue.
- Calculate my total available hours (weekday + weekend, per week and in total) and fit the plan to them exactly. Never plan more hours than I have.
- If my timeline is unrealistic for the role, say so honestly, then give (a) the best plan within my timeline and (b) the realistic timeline needed.
- Prefer free or low-cost resources; name specific courses, books, websites, and practice platforms.

=== OUTPUT STRUCTURE ===
1. Snapshot: my starting point, target role, skill gap analysis (skills I have vs. skills the role needs).
2. Time budget: hours per weekday, per weekend, per week, per month, and total.
3. Phase overview: split the timeline into phases (e.g., Foundations → Core Skills → Projects → Job Hunt) with goals for each.
4. Month-by-month plan: for each month, the goal, skills covered, deliverables, and a milestone to check.
5. Week-by-week plan: for every single week, list what to study on weekdays vs. weekends, with hours allotted to each task, resources, and one measurable output (e.g., "finish SQL module + solve 20 problems").
6. Projects & portfolio: 3–5 role-specific projects, when to build each, and how to present them.
7. Certifications: which ones are worth it for this role and when to take them.
8. Job-hunt plan: resume, LinkedIn, networking, referrals, applications per week, and interview prep (technical + behavioral + case/guesstimates if relevant), mapped to specific weeks.
9. Weekly self-check: a short checklist I review every Sunday, plus what to do if I fall behind.
10. Final readiness checklist for applying.

=== DELIVERABLE ===
- Show the full roadmap in the chat.
- Then generate a well-formatted, downloadable PDF of the complete roadmap with a title page, table of contents, tables for the weekly and monthly plans, and clear headings. Provide the download link.
```

5. Example 1: Fresher to Data Analyst

Domain: Tech | Timeline: 6 months | Hours: 3 on weekdays, 6 on weekends

A fresh B.Com graduate with only basic Excel. Good to test how the prompt handles someone starting almost from zero, with a small budget.

```
ROLE: You are a senior career strategist and hiring manager with deep experience in tech and finance hiring. Build a complete, realistic career roadmap for me.

=== MY DETAILS (filled in by me) ===
1. Current situation:
   - Education (degree, field, year): B.Com, 2025
   - Current job / status: Unemployed, fresh graduate
   - Years of experience and in what: None, one 2-month internship in accounts
   - Current skills (technical and soft): Basic Excel, good communication
   - Tools/software I already know: MS Excel, PowerPoint
   - Certifications I already have: None
   - Location / target job market: Pune, India. Open to remote.
2. Goal:
   - Target domain: Tech
   - Target job role: Data Analyst
   - Target company type: Any MNC or startup
   - What "success" means for me: Get a full-time offer
3. Time commitment:
   - Total timeline: 6 months
   - Weekday hours per day (Mon–Fri): 3 hours
   - Weekend hours per day (Sat–Sun): 6 hours
4. Constraints: Budget under Rs 5,000 for courses

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- If any field is blank or unclear, make a reasonable assumption, state it in an "Assumptions" section, and continue.
- Calculate my total available hours (weekday + weekend, per week and in total) and fit the plan to them exactly. Never plan more hours than I have.
- If my timeline is unrealistic for the role, say so honestly, then give (a) the best plan within my timeline and (b) the realistic timeline needed.
- Prefer free or low-cost resources; name specific courses, books, websites, and practice platforms.

=== OUTPUT STRUCTURE ===
1. Snapshot: my starting point, target role, skill gap analysis (skills I have vs. skills the role needs).
2. Time budget: hours per weekday, per weekend, per week, per month, and total.
3. Phase overview: split the timeline into phases (e.g., Foundations → Core Skills → Projects → Job Hunt) with goals for each.
4. Month-by-month plan: for each month, the goal, skills covered, deliverables, and a milestone to check.
5. Week-by-week plan: for every single week, list what to study on weekdays vs. weekends, with hours allotted to each task, resources, and one measurable output (e.g., "finish SQL module + solve 20 problems").
6. Projects & portfolio: 3–5 role-specific projects, when to build each, and how to present them.
7. Certifications: which ones are worth it for this role and when to take them.
8. Job-hunt plan: resume, LinkedIn, networking, referrals, applications per week, and interview prep (technical + behavioral + case/guesstimates if relevant), mapped to specific weeks.
9. Weekly self-check: a short checklist I review every Sunday, plus what to do if I fall behind.
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```

6. Example 2: Engineer to IB Analyst

Domain: Finance | Timeline: 9 months | Hours: 2 on weekdays, 5 on weekends

A mechanical engineer with a full-time job moving into finance. Good to test a domain switch with limited time.

```
ROLE: You are a senior career strategist and hiring manager with deep experience in tech and finance hiring. Build a complete, realistic career roadmap for me.

=== MY DETAILS (filled in by me) ===
1. Current situation:
   - Education (degree, field, year): B.Tech Mechanical, 2022
   - Current job / status: Employed, career switcher
   - Years of experience and in what: 3 years as a production engineer
   - Current skills (technical and soft): Problem solving, basic Excel, team handling
   - Tools/software I already know: Excel, AutoCAD
   - Certifications I already have: None
   - Location / target job market: Mumbai, India
2. Goal:
   - Target domain: Finance
   - Target job role: Investment Banking Analyst
   - Target company type: Mid-size bank or boutique IB firm
   - What "success" means for me: Get interview calls and one offer
3. Time commitment:
   - Total timeline: 9 months
   - Weekday hours per day (Mon–Fri): 2 hours
   - Weekend hours per day (Sat–Sun): 5 hours
4. Constraints: Can't quit my job during prep

=== STRICT RULES ===
- Do NOT ask me any questions. Do not ask for confirmation. Start immediately.
- If any field is blank or unclear, make a reasonable assumption, state it in an "Assumptions" section, and continue.
- Calculate my total available hours (weekday + weekend, per week and in total) and fit the plan to them exactly. Never plan more hours than I have.
- If my timeline is unrealistic for the role, say so honestly, then give (a) the best plan within my timeline and (b) the realistic timeline needed.
- Prefer free or low-cost resources; name specific courses, books, websites, and practice platforms.

=== OUTPUT STRUCTURE ===
1. Snapshot: my starting point, target role, skill gap analysis (skills I have vs. skills the role needs).
2. Time budget: hours per weekday, per weekend, per week, per month, and total.
3. Phase overview: split the timeline into phases (e.g., Foundations → Core Skills → Projects → Job Hunt) with goals for each.
4. Month-by-month plan: for each month, the goal, skills covered, deliverables, and a milestone to check.
5. Week-by-week plan: for every single week, list what to study on weekdays vs. weekends, with hours allotted to each task, resources, and one measurable output (e.g., "finish SQL module + solve 20 problems").
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7. Example 3: Backend Dev to ML Engineer

Domain: Tech | Timeline: 3 months | Hours: 1.5 on weekdays, 4 on weekends

An experienced developer changing roles on a very tight timeline. This one is a stress test. The prompt should honestly say 3 months is too short, give the best possible 3-month plan, and tell you the realistic timeline.

```
ROLE: You are a senior career strategist and hiring manager with deep experience in tech and finance hiring. Build a complete, realistic career roadmap for me.

=== MY DETAILS (filled in by me) ===
1. Current situation:
   - Education (degree, field, year): B.Tech CSE, 2021
   - Current job / status: Employed
   - Years of experience and in what: 4 years as a Java backend developer
   - Current skills (technical and soft): Java, Spring Boot, SQL, REST APIs, basic Python
   - Tools/software I already know: Git, Docker, AWS basics
   - Certifications I already have: AWS Cloud Practitioner
   - Location / target job market: Bangalore, India. Open to remote.
2. Goal:
   - Target domain: Tech
   - Target job role: Machine Learning Engineer
   - Target company type: Product-based companies
   - What "success" means for me: Land an ML Engineer offer
3. Time commitment:
   - Total timeline: 3 months
   - Weekday hours per day (Mon–Fri): 1.5 hours
   - Weekend hours per day (Sat–Sun): 4 hours
4. Constraints: None

=== STRICT RULES ===
- Do NOT ask me any questions. Do not ask for confirmation. Start immediately.
- If any field is blank or unclear, make a reasonable assumption, state it in an "Assumptions" section, and continue.
- Calculate my total available hours (weekday + weekend, per week and in total) and fit the plan to them exactly. Never plan more hours than I have.
- If my timeline is unrealistic for the role, say so honestly, then give (a) the best plan within my timeline and (b) the realistic timeline needed.
- Prefer free or low-cost resources; name specific courses, books, websites, and practice platforms.

=== OUTPUT STRUCTURE ===
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2. Time budget: hours per weekday, per weekend, per week, per month, and total.
3. Phase overview: split the timeline into phases (e.g., Foundations → Core Skills → Projects → Job Hunt) with goals for each.
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```

8. What your roadmap PDF will contain

Once you run the prompt, this is what you should get. If something is missing, just ask Claude to add it.

Section	What it gives you
Assumptions	Any guesses it made for blank or unclear fields
Snapshot and skill gap	What you have vs. what the role needs
Time budget	Your hours per weekday, weekend, week, month and total
Reality check	An honest note if your timeline is too short, with the realistic timeline
Phase overview	Foundations, core skills, projects, job hunt, with goals for each
Month by month plan	Goal, skills, deliverables and a milestone for each month
Week by week plan	Weekday vs. weekend tasks, hours per task, resources, and one measurable output per week
Projects	3 to 5 role-specific projects, when to build them and how to show them
Certifications	Which ones are worth it and when to take them
Job hunt plan	Resume, LinkedIn, networking, referrals, applications per week, interview prep
Sunday self-check	A weekly checklist and what to do if you fall behind
Readiness checklist	Final list to tick before you start applying

9. Sunday checklist and common mistakes

Your Sunday 15-minute check

Do this every Sunday evening. Your roadmap will have its own version, but this is the base.

	Question
☐	Did I finish this week's measurable output?
☐	How many hours did I actually put in vs. planned?
☐	What was the hardest topic this week? Do I need extra time on it?
☐	Did I do one thing for the job hunt (post, message, application)?
☐	Is next week's plan clear? Do I know what to do on Monday morning?

If you fall behind

- **Behind by a few hours?** Use the next weekend to catch up. Don't touch the plan.
- **Behind by a full week?** Push the plan by one week. Don't try to do two weeks in one.
- **Behind again and again?** Your hours were not realistic. Run the prompt again with your real hours.

Common mistakes

- **Watching more, doing less.** Every week must end with something you built, solved or wrote.
- **Changing the target role every month.** Stick to one role for the full timeline.
- **Skipping projects.** Courses show you learned. Projects show you can do the job.
- **Starting the job hunt too late.** Networking and LinkedIn should start in the first month.
- **Restarting from zero after a bad week.** Adjust and continue. Missing one week is normal.

> **Last thing**
>
> Fill it. Paste it. Print it. Follow it. The best roadmap is the one you actually finish.